# ICH Harmonised Tripartite Guideline: Good Manufacturing Practice for APIs (ICH Q7)

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## 1. Introduction and Scope

This document covers Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP) for active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs) under an appropriate system for managing quality. It is intended to help ensure that APIs meet the requirements for quality and purity that they purport or are represented to possess.

GMP applies starting from the introduction of the API starting material into the manufacturing process and continues through purification, isolation, packaging, and storage.

An API manufacturer should establish and maintain written procedures defining production operations and quality controls.

## 2. Quality Management and Organizational Oversight

Quality should be the responsibility of all persons involved in manufacturing. Each manufacturer should establish, document, and implement an effective system for managing quality that involves the active participation of management and appropriate manufacturing personnel.

There should be an independent quality unit that has responsibility for releasing or rejecting all APIs and raw materials.

## 3. Personnel and Facility Requirements

Personnel should be qualified by education, training, or experience to perform their assigned functions. Buildings and facilities used in the manufacture of APIs should be located, designed, and constructed to facilitate cleaning, maintenance, and operations as appropriate to the type and stage of manufacture.

Appropriate measures should be implemented to prevent cross-contamination and environmental particulate ingress.

## 4. Process Equipment and Documentation Standards

Equipment used in the manufacture, processing, packaging, and holding of an API should be of appropriate design, adequate size, and suitably located for its intended use, cleaning, sanitization, and maintenance. All documents related to the manufacture of APIs should be prepared, reviewed, approved, and distributed according to written procedures.

Critical process equipment should be calibrated according to written procedures and an established schedule.